



Mapping Customer Journeys to Features

Week 2 • Day 5 • Strategic Design & Metrics

TPM Academy



Day 5 Objectives

- Build a **customer journey map** that is grounded in observed evidence, not aspirational fiction
- Surface **non-product touchpoints** (paper, phone, other systems) — the parts most journey maps miss
- Convert friction stars into **3 feature concepts** that link friction → metric → principle
- Defend each feature concept with **trade-offs and validation criteria** — not just upside
- Deliver a **12-minute Week-2 readout** that ties the whole week into one strategy package



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Pin all Week-2 artifacts on the wall
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Anchor the journey
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	Fill the lanes
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	From friction to features
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Readouts	12-min Week-2 readouts

Block 1 — What a Journey Map Is

Anchor in evidence before debating fixes

Is / Is Not

Is	Is not
Timeline of user actions, thoughts, emotions	Flowchart of your product's screens
Grounded in observed + reported behavior	How you wish people used your product
Specific to one persona, one job	"General user" map
A tool to find friction and leverage	An end-state living in a wiki

The TPM job: not the prettiest map. *Find where friction is highest, then connect those points to features that move metrics.*



The Five Swim Lanes

1. **Stage** — Phases of the journey (5–8 stages)
2. **Actions** — Concrete verbs the user is doing
3. **Thoughts** — Quotes from interviews where possible
4. **Emotions** — 4-point curve, plotted
5. **Touchpoints** — Every system & person; **star the friction**

Watch: the emotions curve must *not* be flat. A flat curve means the triad is sanitizing.

Pick One Persona, Pick One Scope

Pre-shift → end-of-shift

A single workday.
Best for journeys
where time-of-day
matters.

First-30-days

Onboarding-heavy.
Best for surfacing
time-to-first-value
friction.

Mid-shift exception

"Tech calls out sick."
The canonical
disruption. High-
fidelity friction.

One persona, one scope. Not "all users, all situations." That's the difference between strategy and a wishlist.

Activity 1 — Anchor the Journey

Triads • 35 minutes

Pick one persona, one scope. Stage the journey (5–8 stages). Sanity-check against Week-1 evidence.

- 5 min: confirm persona
- 10 min: pick scope
- 15 min: stage the journey on the canvas
- 5 min: tag any inferred stage



5 persona • 10 scope • 15 stage • 5 evidence-check

Block 2 — Fill the Lanes

Thoughts, emotions, touchpoints, friction stars



Non-Product Touchpoints (the part most maps miss)

For every stage, list **every system or person** the user interacts with — including paper, phone, other software, manager, customer.

✗ Incomplete map

- Stage: "Reconcile"
- Touchpoint: "FieldPulse mobile"

Misses the actual journey.

✓ Honest map

- Stage: "Reconcile"
- Touchpoints: FieldPulse mobile, paper ticket book, tech's phone, owner's spreadsheet, the printer that jammed

Surfaces the integration story.

Bridge to Week 4: non-product touchpoints become the input to system-component mapping in Week 4.

The Friction Star

Place a star on every stage where the user is fighting the journey.

Friction stars should cluster. If everything is friction, nothing is.

- 2–3 stages with stars → healthy map
- 5+ stages with stars → you're not discriminating; re-rank by severity
- 0 stages with stars → you sanitized the journey; re-listen to interviews

Activity 2 — Fill the Lanes

Triads • 40 minutes

Populate Thoughts, Emotions, Touchpoints. Star the friction. Walk-through review by one member.

- 10 min: thoughts (use real interview quotes when possible)
- 10 min: emotions curve (must vary)
- 15 min: touchpoints (include non-product)
- 5 min: walk-through narration



10 thoughts • 10 emo • 15 touch • 5 walk

Block 3 — From Friction to Features

Three feature concepts that pass the strategy test



The Three-Test Bar

A feature concept earns a place if it passes **all three**:

Test	Question
Friction link	Which specific stage and friction does it reduce?
Metric link	Which operational signal or KPI from your Tier Sheet does it move?
Principle link	Which of your 3 design principles does it align with (or which does it deliberately trade off against)?

The recurring failure: features without metric links. Force the link or kill the feature.



The Feature Card Template

```
## Feature concept: <name>
```

```
</name>
```

```
<strong>Stage(s) addressed:</strong> <journey stages="">  
<strong>Friction reduced:</strong> <specific friction="" starred="" on="" the="" map="">  
<strong>Metric it moves:</strong> <op-signal or="" kpi="">  
<strong>Aligned principle:</strong> <which of the 3>  
<strong>Trade-off / risk:</strong> <what we'd give up; what could go wrong>  
<strong>Validation:</strong> how would we know it actually moved the metric in 30 days?</op-signal></specific></journey>
```

Trade-off / risk is non-negotiable. "No downside" is a failed answer. Every choice forecloses another.

Activity 3 — From Friction to Features

Triads • 40 minutes

Brainstorm 8 candidates. Apply the three-test bar. Cull to 3 with full feature cards.

- 15 min: brainstorm (volume first)
- 15 min: three-test scoring
- 10 min: cull to 3 + complete cards



15 brainstorm • 15 score • 10 cull

Block 4 — Friday Readouts

The full Week-2 strategy package, 12 minutes



The 12-Minute Package

Time	Section	What you cover
1 min	NS + counter-metric	Statement, segment, number
2 min	Tier Sheet causal chain	Three sentences, op-signal → KPI → NS
2 min	One design principle in detail	The one with most expected pushback
4 min	Journey map walk-through	Persona, scope, friction stars
3 min	3 feature concepts	Each: stage / friction / metric / principle

All three voices speak. No single triad-spokesperson. Engineering judges lecturers harshly.



Scoring Rubric (Live)

Dimension	Weight	Exemplary
Metric coherence	25%	Believable causal chain through Tier Sheet
NS defense	20%	Three pitfall rebuttals named & defended
Journey realism	20%	References Week-1 evidence; non-product touchpoints present
Feature linkage	15%	Each feature ties to journey friction AND a metric
AI-use transparency	10%	Provenance log surfaced when relevant
Design awareness	10%	Principle named with trade-off acknowledged

Activity 4 — Readouts

Triads • 12 min present + 3 min Q&A each

Assemble the package. Rehearse with the clock. All three voices on stage.

- 15 min: assemble & order artifacts
- 15 min: rehearse with timer
- 5 min: assign speakers
- 10 min: predict the toughest peer challenge



15 assemble · 15 rehearse · 5 speakers · 10 predict



Week 2 Wrap

What we built this week

- Defensible North Star + counter-metric
- Refreshed Metrics Tier Sheet
- 3 design principles per triad
- AI-Assembled Strategy Brief with provenance
- Customer journey map + 3 feature concepts

What opens Week 3

- **Requirements Engineering & Mini-Capstone**
- Convert your top feature concept → full **Technical PRD** (non-AI)
- Acceptance Criteria, NFRs, peer-review cycle
- Mini-capstone delivers Friday Week 3

Bring to Monday: All six Week-2 artifacts in shareable form. The journey map and feature cards are direct PRD inputs.

Questions & Reflection

Where does your map disagree with how your product was designed?